I have grown accustomed to batting with a towel tucked into my waist at the front. I've always had issues with sweat and sensitive eyes, and I use the towel to wipe away the sweat. In fact, I don't feel right when I don't have a towel tucked into my waist – that's about as close to a superstition as I get.

Puma has been providing me with top-quality footwear for as long as I remember, and I always keep both a pair of batting shoes and a pair of fielding shoes in my bag.

Carefully prepared and properly equipped, I am then ready to go out and play for South Africa. That's what I do. I play *for* South Africa. That is, and will always be, the greatest privilege of my life.

What kind of South Africa? In my mind, it's the South Africa described by Alan Paton in his book *Cry, the Beloved Country*, which was published back in 1948. It is, as he wrote, 'a great and peaceful South Africa in which the world will take pride, a nation in which each of many different groups will be making its own creative contribution'.

We have some work to do, but we'll get there.